

Student Mental Health & Social Media

What the Power BI dashboard tells a decision-maker

A simple, business-style interpretation of the dashboard — focused on questions, evidence, meaning, and action.

705 Students Ages 18–24	4.92 h Avg. daily social media use Per student	64% Report academic impact Self-reported	6.87 h Avg. sleep Per night
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Executive takeaway

The dashboard points to one clear stakeholder issue: social media use is high, and 64% of students say it affects their academic performance. At the same time, average sleep is below 7 hours. The most practical response is targeted awareness and support — especially for younger students — rather than assuming one platform is the cause of poor outcomes.

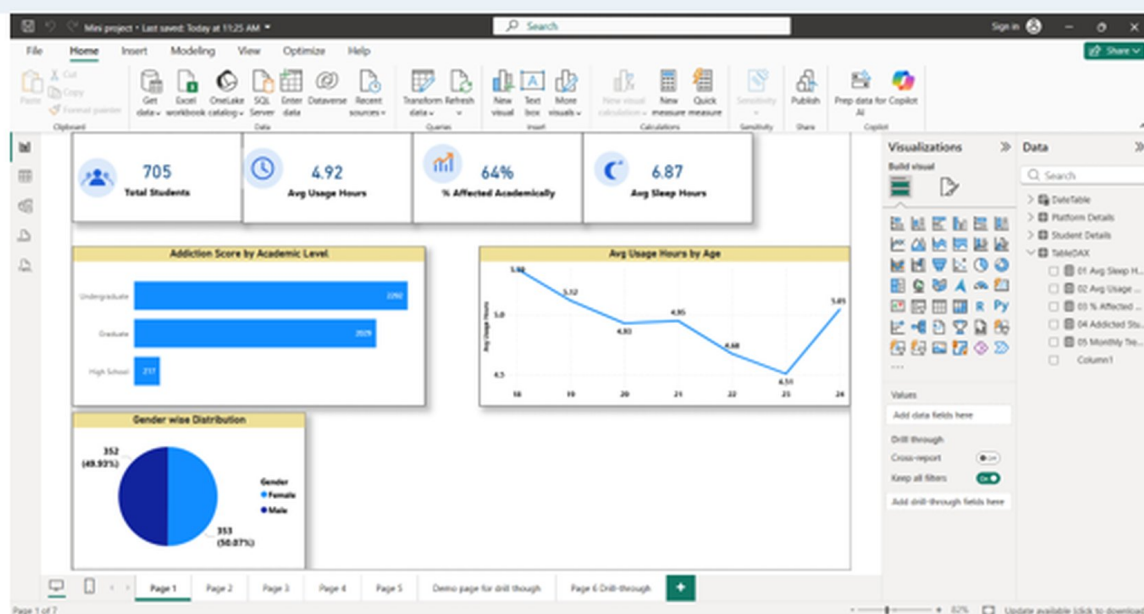


Figure 1. Main Power BI dashboard overview.

Prepared from the supplied Power BI dashboard. The figures below describe the dataset shown in the dashboard; they do not establish medical or causal relationships.

1. The stakeholder questions this dashboard answers

Stakeholder question	Dashboard answer	What it means
How large is the population?	705 students aged 18–24 are included.	The dashboard gives a clear view of the target student population.
How much social media are students using?	4.92 hours per day on average.	Usage is high enough to justify looking at possible links with study and wellbeing.
Do students feel academics are affected?	64% say social media affects their academic performance.	This is the strongest business signal in the dashboard.
Which students use social media the most?	High school students average 5.5 hours/day, versus 5.0 for undergraduates and 4.8 for graduates.	Younger students are a logical priority segment for prevention and awareness.
Which platforms matter most?	Instagram, TikTok and Facebook have the largest student counts.	These platforms offer the broadest reach for communication or awareness campaigns.
Is there a sleep concern?	Average sleep is 6.87 hours/night.	Sleep should be treated as a wellbeing metric to watch alongside usage.
Can the dashboard be explored by segment?	Yes — country, academic level, gender and age filters are available, plus Gender and Academic Level view toggles.	Stakeholders can move from the overall picture to a specific student segment.
Can a stakeholder inspect individual records?	Yes — drill-through shows student-level sleep, usage, addiction score, platform, conflict and mental-health rating.	Useful for spot-checking records and explaining the underlying detail behind summary views.

2. What the dashboard is really saying

1 — Academic impact is the clearest stakeholder signal

64% of students report that social media affects their academic performance. This does not prove that social media caused the academic issue, but it shows a large self-reported concern that deserves attention.

2 — The youngest students deserve closer attention

High school students have the highest average usage at 5.5 hours/day. They are the smallest academic-level group, so the result should be monitored rather than over-generalized.

3 — Three platforms dominate reach

Instagram, TikTok and Facebook have the largest student counts. For a broad communication campaign, these are the most useful channels to test first.

4 — Sleep is a second warning signal

Average sleep is 6.87 hours/night. Combined with nearly five hours of daily social-media use, this makes sleep a sensible wellbeing KPI to monitor.

5 — The gender split is balanced, but platform preference differs

The sample is almost evenly split: 352 female and 353 male students. Platform preference is not identical by gender; Instagram is more female-skewed, while Facebook and WhatsApp are more male-skewed.

6 — Most students are not in a low wellbeing band, but there is room to improve

The dashboard summary groups students as 60% “Average” and 40% “Good,” with no lower/at-risk band shown in this dataset. This is reassuring, but it also suggests an opportunity to move more students from Average to Good.

Important interpretation rule

Use the dashboard to identify patterns and priority groups. Do not describe the results as proof that a specific platform “causes” poor mental health, poor grades, or sleep problems. The dashboard is observational and self-reported.

3. Segment analysis: where a stakeholder should look first

Dimension	Dashboard signal	Stakeholder interpretation
Age	18-year-olds: 5.39 h/day	Highest average usage in the age trend.
Age	23-year-olds: 4.51 h/day	Lowest point in the age trend; usage rises again to 5.05 h at age 24.
Academic level	High School: 5.5 h/day	Highest average usage; small cohort, so interpret carefully.
Academic level	Graduate: 4.8 h/day	Lowest average usage among the three academic levels.
Gender	Female: ~5.0 h/day	Slightly higher usage than males.
Gender	Male: ~4.8 h/day	Small gap versus females; not a major difference.
Platform	Instagram	Largest platform group in the dashboard.
Platform	TikTok	Second-largest platform group.
Platform	Facebook	Third-largest platform group.
Relationship	Single: 54%	Largest relationship-status segment.
Relationship	In relationship: 41%	Second-largest segment.
Relationship	Complicated: 5% / 32 students	Small segment; relationship-specific insights should be interpreted cautiously.

How to use the filters

- Country: compare a large country group or explore whether a pattern is concentrated in a location.
- Academic level: isolate high school, undergraduate, or graduate students.
- Gender: compare platform and usage patterns without changing the rest of the dashboard logic.
- Age range: focus the dashboard on a narrower student age segment.
- Drill-through: move from a summary pattern to individual student-level details.

4. What should the stakeholder do next?

Recommended action	Why it matters	Potential owner
1. Prioritize academic-impact awareness	Because 64% report academic impact, make study-focus, notification control and healthy social-media habits part of student support messaging.	Student support / academic teams
2. Test a younger-student intervention	High school students show the highest average usage (5.5 h/day). Use a focused pilot before scaling it to the full population.	Student wellbeing / school teams
3. Use the highest-reach platforms first	Start awareness content on Instagram, TikTok and Facebook because these have the largest student counts in the dashboard.	Communications / wellbeing teams
4. Track sleep together with usage	Do not monitor screen time alone. Pair usage with sleep in future reporting to see whether the two move together across segments.	Wellbeing analytics
5. Build a monthly trend view	The current dashboard is mainly descriptive. A time-based view would help stakeholders see whether interventions are improving outcomes.	BI / analytics team
6. Improve the relationship analysis	Create an average conflict score by relationship status instead of showing only the number of students in each category.	BI developer / data analyst

Best next dashboard upgrade

Add a time dimension and a small set of trend KPIs: average usage, average sleep, academic-impact %, average addiction score, average mental-health rating, and average conflict score. That would turn this from a descriptive dashboard into a stronger decision-monitoring dashboard.

5. Data and dashboard notes a stakeholder should know

Note	Why it matters
The "Academic Performance Impact by Platform" view should be read as counts, not causation.	It shows how many students fall into the reported impact categories by most-used platform; it does not show that the platform itself caused the academic effect.
The "Conflict Level by Relationship Status" chart needs a clearer measure.	The current view displays group sizes (384, 289, 32) rather than an average conflict score per relationship group. A better stakeholder metric would be Avg Conflict Level by Relationship Status.
Country-level comparisons need caution.	The population is global, but many countries have only one or two students. Large country groups should be interpreted more

	confidently than tiny groups.
Use descriptive language.	Prefer “students report,” “the dashboard shows,” and “the data suggests a pattern” over causal wording such as “Instagram causes lower grades.”
Student-level drill-through is useful for validation.	It allows an analyst to spot-check the individual data behind summary visuals and explain unusual values.

6. One-minute stakeholder summary

This dashboard covers 705 students aged 18–24 and shows relatively high social-media use at 4.92 hours per day. The strongest stakeholder signal is academic impact: 64% of students report that social media affects their academic performance. High school students have the highest average usage at 5.5 hours per day, while Instagram, TikTok and Facebook are the largest platforms. Average sleep is 6.87 hours, which makes sleep a useful wellbeing KPI alongside screen time. The dashboard supports segmentation by age, gender, academic level and country, and it also provides student-level drill-through. The best next step is not to assume causation, but to use these patterns to target awareness, pilot interventions with younger students, and improve the dashboard with trends and cleaner measures.

Portfolio positioning

This is a good BI project because it demonstrates more than chart creation: KPI design, stakeholder questions, segmentation, drill-through, filtering, business interpretation, and awareness of data-quality / causality limitations.